Memorandum of the course of actions taken towards the aboriginal territory of Formosa.

(No 10)

On the 3rd day of the 10th month (and 7 year) Yanagiwara, the Minister Okubo, the Ambassador, exchanged the agreement and the contract with the Prince Kong and Chinese officials, at the Tsung-li-yamen in the following manner:

agreement

His Excellency, Okubo, the Special ambassador of H. I. M. the Tenno of Japan, Sangi and the Secretary of the interior affairs, on the one part, and their Excellencies, the high officials (here are the names of

the Prince Kong and nine other Chinese officials) of the Tsung-li-yamen of China on the other part, being desirous to consult mutually the points of agreement and to draw up the document of settlement; furthermore, they being mutually agreed that, if there should be any need to protect her own subject from injury, by any state, she shall be held to take the measures necessary for it, and that; if there should occur any event within the dominion of any state, she shall be held to take its settlement in her own hand,

And furthermore, they being mutually agreed that the design of Japan in despatching her troops to Formosa, is to punish the savages there, who committed the crimes of injuring the Japanese subjects.

アジア歴史資料センター
Japan Center for Asian Historical Records
http://www.jacar.go.jp/

And furthermore, they having consulted together on the mode of the evacuation of the Aboriginal territory by the Japanese troops and of preserving the friendly relation between the two countries, have agreed the following three articles;

Article 1. The present enterprise of Japan is a just and rightful action to protect her own subjects, and China does not designate it as a wrong action.

Article 11. A sum of solace shall be given by China, to the family of the shipwrecked Japanese subjects, injured by the Formosan savages, to indemnify them. It is also stipulated that another sum shall be paid by China to Japan for the roads, houses and others which have been made by the Japanese, in the Aborigi-

nal territory, and which China desires to retain for her own use. Their amounts are determined by a special document.

Article 111. All the official correspondences, hitherto passed between the two states, shall be returned mutually and be annulled, to prevent any future misunderstanding. As to the Formosan savage, China engages to take the proper measures for controlling them and perpetually to protect the navigators from an injury, on the part of the savages.

Contract.

With regard to the question of Formosa, Wade, the Minister of Great Britain has discussed the subject with the commissioners of the two countries

countries, and to-day they have come to terms for the settlement of the matter:

First; China agrees that she shall pay the sum of one hundred thousand taels as the solace to the wretched people of Japan who were treated violently.

Secondly; China wish, that after Japan should have let her troops retire, all the roads which have been repaired and all the houses which have been built and like should be allowed to be retained for her own use, at the same time consenting to pay the sum of five hundred thousand taels by way of cost; and a conference having been held, it is agreed that Japan should let all her troops retire and China should pay the whole

sums without fail, on the 20th day of December, the seventh year of Meiji, with Japan, or on the 12th day of the eleventh moon, the thirteenth year of Tung chi, with China, but, that in event of Japan not letting her all troops retire, China should not pay the whole sums.

Thus terms having been concluded both parties have taken one copy of the contract as voucher.

On the same day, the Ambassador ordered Colonel Furuhara Wakatsu and others who accompanied him, to return to Japan and to forward the documents concerning the Formosan question to the government.

On the 1st November the ambassador and others left Pekin and on the

the 3rd arrived at Tien-tsin, where they were met by Lihung chang with whom they congratulated for the future peace, promising that the mutual amity between the two nations will more and more consolidated on the 9th, they arrived at Shang hai on the 8th, chief points of the agreement was telegramed to the Japanese government, with the information that he himself will visit Aboriginal Formosa and suggest to General Saigo that all the arrangements for its evacuation should be performed.

On the 9th the government after having hold a council on the subject of this telegram announced it to all its departments, while to the Army and Navy a special order was secretly given

that the preparations for the war shall be still continued, till an order should be given afterwards.

On the 11th, the ambassador's attaches who had returned directly from the continent, arrived at Tokio, on the 12th, His Majesty visited the Seiin to hear the report which they brought with them.

On the 13th, Fujii cho Higashi Kuze Michi Tomi was dispatched to Aboriginal Formosa in order to make General Saigo return back triumphantly leading all his troops, and an imperial letter was delivered up. on the 17th, the new agreement and the deed of contract were published through the whole Empire.

On the 27th, the Ambassador Okubo Toshimichi landing at the port of Yokohama immediately came

アジア歴史資料センター
Japan Center for Asian Historical Records
http://www.jacar.go.jp/

to the Daijokwan and presented his memorial a summary of which is as foldows:

"Our expedition to Aboriginal Formosa was an act which is appealing to the Heaven and earth and gods as well as to all the nations in the world should bring on our empire no disgrace and which is a most honorable policy of our dynasty. But for the former negotiation between our Ambassador to China and the Tsung-li-yamen on the spring of the last year left no written proof and as a part of Chinese dominion, many of foreigners and our people reproach the policy of the government or doubt the propriety of its action, thus confusing its truth."

"Moreover Chinese government entertaining an opinion different from ours, it was very difficult that a decided point of war or peace could be settled readily. They pretending on the maintenance of peace instead of earnestly contending for the superiority with us aimed at a possibility of charging us with a wrong name. Therefore though the negotiation had not come to a point of agreement yet we could not have an opportunity to declare the war but waited patiently for the opening of it by them, because the object of the expedition to Aboriginal Formosa which was our obligation, had been already gained. This was a fact for which we could not hastily decide for war. They attempted under the mark of mutual amity to make our troops evaquate Formosa for naught.

アジア歴史資料センター
Japan Center for Asian Historical Records
http://www.jacar.go.jp/

" naught and to take on themselves
" its future management. At first, Mr.
" Yanagiwara discussed this matter
" and afterwards, J. Toshi Michi fol-
" lowed him. But there being no oppor-
" tunity suddenly to express our claim
" of indemnity we had to resort to the
" two questions by which they would
" obey to the right and justice. This
" was another fact by which the nego-
" tiation could not speedily result
" in peace. These two facts happening
" to be the case, my power of persua-
" tion was exhausted and little pro-
" gress was made in this matter till
" the present. This was the cause that
" I Toshi michi could not accomplis-
" sh my mission with a satisfactory
" result, although we were compelled
" by the necessity of circumstance."

On the 3rd of December, General Saigo departed from Formosa with the whole force; and, on the same day, he made the following proclamation to the tamed savages:

"The intention of our coming here
" had already been announced; and,
" as you have well understood our mo-
" tives and offered best assistance
" which lay at your power; all the
" wild savages trembled and bowed
" before our arms. Though after this,
" we occupied the land, owing to the
" opposition which was made to our
" act by the Chinese government, the
" negotiation between the two countries
" having been brought to a conclution,
" we have ceded all the land to the
" government according to its demands.
" We well know, and deeply acknowl-
" ledge, a good and affectionate filial
feeling

"feeling which you hade showed toward
"us; and heartily recommend you, that,
"henceforth, you will so well love the
"Chinese officials as you did us, and
"nobly obey her law, without making
"any apposition."

To the wild savages, he made
proclamation as follows:

"A few years ago, the Boutans
"committed an inpardonable crime,
"by murdering some of our Loochoo-
"ian subjects, and I, Yorimichi,
"respectfully obeying our imperial
"order, came and chastised you.
"But you having repented your
"own vice and asked your mercy, I
"has forgiven you, expecting you
"would live a peaceful and long
"life under our Imperial benign
"government. But now, the nego-
"ciation with the Chinese government

"has complied with all its demands,
"and we should leave the island ere
"long. Henceforth you would nobly obey
"the Chinese law, without making any
"apposition."

On the 7th the same month,
general Saigo arrived at Nagasaki,
and on the 27th he arrived at Tokio
and immediately made the report of
his mission.

Of the ten Numbers of the
Memorandum the first one has been
compiled from different public
documents, by Hirai Yoshimasa, the Gaimushojo
and others. The remainder I have accor-
ding to official instruction, gathered
from the reports of various dispatched
officers as they appear, mentioning
also

also the internal circumstances where it seems well to do so. There has been necessarily produced many and wide differences in the degree of the particularity of narrations, owing to the dispatch which was occationally needed of compiling and, after it, sending it to press; and there is some want of uniformity in the names of departments, offices, boards etc. in many places, owing to the same causes. But in the matters relating to the negotiation which took place between both countries, I have been extremely careful. There are occationally inserted some opinions, this has been made by the instruction from our chief K. B. Okuma Shigenobu. On the whole, it has been my object to be brief and yet particular on

the subject. The memorandums were originally intended for the foreign and internal publication when circumstances needed. But, now, the cabinet has ordered it to be kept secret, only to be preserved for future references; except to be showed confidencially to our ministers and consuls residing in foreign countries.

In the board of Formosan affairs, this 4th January, 8th year of Meiji.

Noguchi Tsunetomo

Gonshonaishi.